

Drug Monograph: Metformin Hydrochloride

Therapeutic Class: Biguanide Antihyperglycemic Agent.

Indications: First-line management of Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus.

Dosing: Initial 500 mg orally once or twice daily with meals. Increase weekly by 500 mg up to maximum 2000-2550 mg/day in divided doses.

Contraindications and Warnings: Severe renal impairment (eGFR < 30 mL/min/1.73m²), acute metabolic acidosis, severe hepatic impairment, acute congestive heart failure. Black Box Warning for Lactic Acidosis.

Drug Monograph: Lisinopril

Therapeutic Class: Angiotensin-Converting Enzyme (ACE) Inhibitor.

Indications: Hypertension, Heart Failure with reduced ejection fraction, Post-Myocardial Infarction.

Dosing: Hypertension initial 10 mg once daily, titrating to 20-40 mg once daily. Heart failure initial 2.5-5 mg daily.

Adverse Effects & Warnings: Dry persistent cough, hyperkalemia, angioedema, hypotension. Contraindicated in pregnancy (fetal toxicity) and concomitant use with Aliskiren in diabetic patients.

Drug Monograph: Empagliflozin

Therapeutic Class: Sodium-Glucose Cotransporter 2 (SGLT2) Inhibitor.

Indications: Type 2 Diabetes, Heart Failure (HFrEF and HFpEF), Chronic Kidney Disease.

Dosing: 10 mg orally once daily in the morning with or without food. May increase to 25 mg once daily for glycemic control.

Adverse Effects & Precautions: Mycotic genital infections, urinary tract infections, volume depletion/hypotension, euglycemic ketoacidosis. Discontinue at least 3 days prior to major surgery to avoid DKA.

Drug Monograph: Atorvastatin Calcium

Therapeutic Class: HMG-CoA Reductase Inhibitor (Statin).

Indications: Hypercholesterolemia, Primary and Secondary Prevention of Cardiovascular Events.

Dosing: Moderate-intensity: 10-20 mg daily. High-intensity: 40-80 mg once daily.

Adverse Reactions: Myopathy, rhabdomyolysis, elevated transaminases, modest increase in HbA1c/blood glucose.
Contraindicated in active liver disease and pregnancy.